

Accessible Moderation Reference

Beacon Field Research | Internal practice guide | Synthetic Study Alpha context

Purpose

Accessible moderation means designing the conversation so people can participate without unnecessary friction. Ask about preferences, not diagnoses; let the participant choose the pace, channel, and breaks.

This reference uses the Study Alpha anchor (2026-07-13 / UX-184 / planned n=24) as a synthetic working example.

Before the session

Offer the discussion guide and activity format in advance when useful. Confirm captioning, interpreter, screen-reader, keyboard, low-vision, language, sensory, or fatigue-related preferences without requiring disclosure. Share a contact route for adjustments and a clear no-penalty cancellation option.

Check	Prompt	Moderator response
Format	"What would make this session easier to take part in?"	Adapt pace, channel, materials, or activity.
Comprehension	"Would you like me to restate that another way?"	Use plain language; do not repeat louder.
Breaks	"Would a pause be helpful?"	Offer without making the person justify it.

During moderation

Use one question at a time, leave thinking space, and describe any visual material aloud. Avoid interpreting silence as agreement. For tasks, invite a participant to choose whether to operate, direct, observe, or skip the activity.

If an accommodation changes the method, document the change neutrally in the session log so interpretation is appropriately cautious.

Repair and close

When you misunderstand, say so plainly and ask for correction. At close, summarize in your own words, ask what you missed, and clarify follow-up boundaries. Never pressure a participant to disclose a condition or explain an access need.

Accessibility is a research-quality practice: it improves the evidence available to the team and reduces avoidable moderator influence.